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The Solo *AI Agency* Kit

30 plays I actually run to ship client work with AI — the agency moves and the Claude Code workflow behind every reel on this page.

20 Agency Plays | 10 Claude Code Power Moves | No fluff · do-today

01

The Agency Playbook

Twenty things that moved the needle for a one-person AI agency — pricing, getting clients, killing busywork, and keeping them. Steal what fits.

PLAY 01

Automation runs my back office

Pick the three jobs you redo every week — **invoicing, client onboarding, weekly reports** — and wire each as one n8n flow. Back-office first, because it pays you back every single week without touching delivery.

PLAY 02

Stop paying for Zapier

Most paid Zaps are a webhook, a filter, and an API call. Rebuild them as **self-hosted n8n** nodes. Same outcome, no per-task tax — the bill stops scaling with your volume.

PLAY 03

AI agencies are simpler than you think

One niche, one offer, one repeatable workflow. Complexity is where solo agencies die. **Sell the same outcome to the same buyer** until the system is boring — then scale it.

PLAY 04

I charged too little

Price the **outcome, not the hours**. "A booking system that fills your calendar" is worth far more than "12 hours of setup." Anchor high, then let the package justify it.

PLAY 05

One change to my proposals

Open with **their** result, not your bio. First line = the problem they typed, restated sharper, plus the outcome you'll deliver. Save the credentials for the bottom.

PLAY 06

ChatGPT got this wrong

AI is the intern, you're the QA. **Never ship raw output.** The agencies that win treat the model as a fast first draft and put a human checkpoint on everything client-

facing.

PLAY 07

Stuck building cheap sites

Escape the race to the bottom by **productizing**: a named package, a fixed scope, a clear result. You stop selling hours and start selling a thing people can picture buying.

PLAY 08

New to Upwork? Read this

Structure every proposal: **mirror their words → one proof → 2 sharp questions → presumptive CTA**. Questions make you a consultant, not a vendor — and they get replies.

PLAY 09

Your first automation is simple

Don't boil the ocean. Take **one** task you do by hand today, map the trigger and the steps, automate just that. One working flow beats a grand plan that never ships.

PLAY 10

Cold outreach that actually works

Personalized first line, one piece of proof, a **soft** CTA ("worth a quick look?"). Volume without relevance gets ignored — relevance without a clear ask gets nowhere.

PLAY 11

My AI stack killed busywork

The core: **Claude Code** for build + content, **n8n** for automation, one CRM for follow-up. Few tools, deeply used, beats a graveyard of half-set-up apps.

PLAY 12

I almost quit my agency

The fix was **niching down**. Doing everything for everyone burned me out and confused buyers. One niche made marketing, pricing, and delivery click into place.

PLAY 13

The pricing advice I ignored

Retainers over one-offs. Recurring revenue turns the feast-or-famine cycle into a baseline. Build the one-off, then convert it into a "keep it running" monthly.

PLAY 14

AEO isn't what you think

It's early and unhyped: making your business **findable when people ask an AI**, not just Google. Clean structured info, real third-party presence, consistent facts. Build the footprint now.

PLAY 15

This kills client retention

Silence. Clients churn when they can't **see** the value. A simple monthly "here's what we did + what's next" keeps a result-delivering retainer alive far longer than the work alone.

PLAY 16

One node replaced a paid tool

Before you buy another SaaS, ask if it's **one n8n node**. Form-to-sheet, notify-on-event, scrape-and-send — a lot of monthly tools are a single step you already own.

PLAY 17

AI won't replace you

The person **wielding** AI replaces the person who won't. Judgment, taste, and client trust are the moat. Use the model to move faster, not to think for you.

PLAY 18

Still doing invoices by hand?

Trigger → template → send → log, all automated. Invoicing is the cleanest first automation: clear rules, real time saved, and it **pays you** to set up.

PLAY 19

Scaling is brutal

Systems before people. Document and automate the repeatable parts first. Hiring into chaos just multiplies the chaos — hiring into a system multiplies output.

PLAY 20

3 ways to get clients

> **Referrals** (ask every happy client), **content** (show the work in public), **outreach** (targeted, proof-led). Run all three on a light, consistent cadence — not in bursts.

02

Claude Code Power Moves

The ten workflow moves that let one person ship like a team. This is how every reel, site, and automation in the agency actually gets built.

MOVE 21

CLAUDE.md is your memory

Put the facts that are **always true** — stack, conventions, deploy gotchas — in a CLAUDE.md at the repo root. The agent reads it every session, so you stop re-explaining your project.

MOVE 22

Use the plan-mode gate

Before any multi-file or billable change, make it **plan first, execute after approval**. The plan is your sign-off and your spec — it catches wrong turns before they cost you.

MOVE 23

Give Claude a check

Have a **separate** agent grade the work against a rubric before it ships — the builder shouldn't mark its own homework. An independent critic pass kills the "looks done but isn't" bug.

MOVE 24

Subagents save your context

Push research and big searches into **subagents**. They burn their own context and hand you back the conclusion, so your main thread stays clean and on-task for longer.

MOVE 25

Turn a prompt into a skill

Any workflow you'd paste twice becomes a **reusable skill** — name, triggers, steps. You stop re-prompting from scratch and start running a house procedure on command.

MOVE 26

Hooks are guardrails

Wire **hooks** to enforce the rules automatically — block a risky command, inject context, run a check on save. Guardrails the harness enforces beat rules you have to remember.

MOVE 27

Fan out across files

Independent subtasks on **disjoint files**? Launch them in parallel in one message. Work that took an afternoon in sequence collapses to one pass of wall-clock time.

MOVE 28

Run parallel worktrees

Give each parallel agent its own **git worktree** so they never collide. Isolated branches mean one agent's crash can't take down the others — and every change is a clean, revertable unit.

MOVE 29

Checkpoints & rewind

Experiment fearlessly: **checkpoint** before a risky change and rewind if it goes sideways. Safe undo turns "I hope this works" into "let's just try it."

MOVE 30

Headless CI review

Run the agent **headless** to review every PR before a human looks. Automated first-pass review catches the obvious stuff so your attention goes to what actually matters.

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Want this run on *your* brand?

Everything in this kit — the automations, the content engine, the build workflow — is what SkynetLabs sets up for clients. If you'd rather have it done than do it, that's the work.

Book a free discovery call
skynetjoe.com/discovery-call

— or comment “AI” on the reel and grab the pinned link —

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